THE CHATSHACK C.I.C.

1st Contact & Initial Support Form

Peer-Led Mental Health Support Community • Adults 18+

SAFE SPACE • CONFIDENTIAL • NON-JUDGEMENTAL • FREE

This form is intended to help us understand how we can best welcome, assist, support and, where appropriate, gently challenge you. You do not have to share anything you are not comfortable sharing.

1. YOUR DETAILS

Full name:	
Preferred name:	
Telephone:	
Email:	
Preferred contact method:	■ Phone ■ Text ■ WhatsApp ■ Email ■ Other

Emergency contact (optional):

Name:	
Relationship:	
Telephone:	

2. WHY HAVE YOU MADE CONTACT TODAY?

What has brought you to The ChatShack today? Please use your own words. You can keep this brief.

3. WHAT WOULD YOU LIKE FROM THE CHATSHACK?

Which of the following would be helpful to you at the moment? Tick any that apply.

■ Someone to listen	■ Peer support	■ One-to-one support
■ Group support	■ Meeting new people / friendship	■ Walk & Talk
■ Activities / wellbeing	■ Help finding other support	■ Practical signposting
■ Just somewhere safe to talk	■ I am not sure yet	■ Other: _____

4. HOW CAN WE ASSIST, SUPPORT & CHALLENGE YOU?

Is there anything you would like us to help you with? This could include confidence, isolation, communication, routines, relationships, wellbeing, getting involved, or taking a small step forward.

THE CHATSHACK C.I.C. — 1st CONTACT

Understanding what feels comfortable for you

5. IS THERE ANYTHING YOU WOULD FIND DIFFICULT INITIALLY?

We understand that starting something new can feel difficult. Is there anything you would be uncomfortable doing at first, or anything you would prefer us not to ask you to do until you are ready?

6. WHAT WOULD HELP YOU FEEL SAFE & COMFORTABLE?

For example: meeting someone first, sitting near an exit, attending with someone you know, starting with a one-to-one conversation, joining a group gradually, or simply having someone check in with you.

7. SUPPORT & SAFEGUARDING CHECK

Is there anything happening right now that you feel The ChatShack needs to know in order to support you safely? You do not need to provide detailed information here. If there is an immediate danger or emergency, The ChatShack is not an emergency service and appropriate emergency/professional support may be needed.

8. YOUR PREFERRED NEXT STEP

■ Attend a group	■ One-to-one chat
■ Meet a peer mentor	■ Join a WhatsApp support group
■ Take part in an activity	■ Walk & Talk
■ Be contacted later	■ Not sure yet

9. INITIAL CONTACT NOTES — CHATSHACK USE

Date:		Completed by:	
Initial support offered:		Follow-up required:	■ Yes ■ No
Agreed next step:		Review / follow-up date:	

Confidentiality: Information will be handled in accordance with The ChatShack's Privacy Notice, Data Protection procedures and applicable UK data-protection requirements. Confidentiality has reasonable limits where information needs to be shared to protect someone from serious harm, address safeguarding concerns, meet legal duties, or respond to an emergency.